

Assignment 2.16: Observing Communication in the Workplace

Overview and Purpose:

- A Workplace Observation is when you go to “look and see” at a workplace for a short time, 20 minutes to 1 hour.
- The aim is to see different jobs and work environments, different forms of communication, and customer service behaviors.
- You can do this on your way home at a public space such as a café, bank, hospital, construction site or store. These locations should not require you to ask for permission.
- You can also conduct an observation after acquiring formal permission through a process similar to that of arranging an informational interview. This approach will be needed at places that require access into a workplace, where you can stand out of the way in a space that does not require safety clothing. Examples of these situations include a car repair workshop, panel beating workshop, or inside a restaurant kitchen.
- By doing observations, you start to build a relationship with an employer. This will make it easier to ask to come back for an informational interview, job shadowing or for your 1-day work experience.

Observation Questions:

With a partner, you will do observations at 2 different workplaces. Decide in advance who will be Observer #1 and Observer #2 for each one (switching roles for the two workplaces). Each person is responsible for being able to answer the questions assigned to them. When describing a job they observed, both people should describe different jobs (where possible). This means that for example in a restaurant, one person would observe the cashier and the other the waiter.

Everyone	Observer #1	Observer #2
What is the name of the company?	What job did you observe? What did they do and what equipment did they use?	What job did you observe? What did they do and what equipment did they use?
What type of business is it?	What forms of communication did you see?	Describe any good customer service you saw.
What products or services does the business offer?	How did the supervisor communicate with the employees?	Describe any bad customer service you saw.
Complete the questions in the form to the best of your ability.		

Workplace Observation Form (Visit #1)	
Your Name:	Ali Naser
Date/Duration of Observation :	July 24, 2026 - 2 hours
Name of Company Observed:	Huawei Technologies Lebanon
Number of Employees You Saw:	5 employees
Type of Industry: (e.g.: Manufacturing, Hospitality, IT, Service)	Telecommunications and ICT services
What the Company Does: What services do they offer, what do they make, what do they do?	Huawei provides ICT infrastructure and smart technology. Its work includes network equipment, smartphones and other smart devices, cloud and computing solutions, and research and development.
Tasks Observed: What tasks/work do you see taking place?	Employees trained students, presented technical topics, coordinated with universities, and handled HR and administrative duties. Different departments worked together to organize these activities.
Skills Observed: What skills do you see being used?	Communication, presentation, organization, teamwork, coordination, and technical knowledge of telecommunications networks.
Working Hours: What are start and finish times? What are tea and lunch break times?	Employees generally begin between 8:00 and 9:00 AM and finish between 5:00 and 6:00 PM. Their lunch break is around midday.
Employee Interaction: Can you observe how employees interact with each other? Describe what you see.	Staff communicated professionally and respectfully. Colleagues sharing the same office appeared more relaxed, friendly, and comfortable with one another.
Employee Satisfaction: Do the employees look happy, like they are enjoying their job? Explain why you think this.	They seemed confident and comfortable while completing their duties. This suggested that they understood their roles and were genuinely interested in their work.
Customers: Who are the main customers?	Individual users, telecom operators such as Alfa, Touch, and Ogero, and institutions such as hospitals and universities.
Customer Service (1): What did you notice?	Staff listened carefully and gave clear, knowledgeable explanations.
Customer Service (2): Did you observe any good or bad interactions with customers?	The interactions were positive. Employees answered questions patiently and made sure customers and trainees understood the information.
Main Relevant Jobs Observed (1): List a job you observed. Briefly, what does this job involve?	HR Specialist Handles recruitment, employee relations, and daily human-resources operations.

Main Relevant Jobs Observed (2): List a job you observed. Briefly, what does this job involve?	PR & ICT Ecosystem Specialist Builds relationships with universities and coordinates student training programs, competitions, and recruitment activities.
Main Relevant Jobs Observed (3): List a job you observed. Briefly, what does this job involve?	Training Instructor Delivers lessons to trainees and explains networking and telecommunications concepts.
Main Equipment Observed: List and explain some of the main equipment you saw?	Routers were used to demonstrate 4G network topology. Laptops and presentation equipment were also used during the training.
Devices that Were used for Customer Service: What devices were used when the staff interacted with customers?	Employees used laptops and tablets to display information and communicate with customers and trainees.
Workplace Safety (1): Did you see any health and safety signs? Describe and draw them on the back of this form.	I did not notice any visible health or safety signs in the areas that I observed.
Workplace Safety (2): Did you see any safety clothing? Describe it.	No special protective clothing was required in the office and training areas.
Dress Code: What do you notice about how the workers are dressed?	Employees wore formal business clothing that matched the company's corporate environment.
Workplace Energy: Does this look like a fun or interesting place to work? Why/why not?	Yes. The workplace felt organized, active, and technology-focused, with employees involved in training, networking, and university coordination.
Possible Work Experience Opportunities: Do you think there might be work experience or internship opportunities here? Why?	Yes. Huawei runs training programs for university students, so internships or practical work-experience opportunities may be available.
Manager or Supervisor's Name: List here if you were able to get this information.	Ms. Ruba Msheik - PR & ICT Ecosystem Specialist Ms. Patricia Farah - Senior HR Specialist I did not directly observe a manager or supervisor.

Workplace Observation Form (Visit #2)	
Your Name:	Ali Naser
Date/Duration of Observation :	July 24, 2026 - 2 hours
Name of Company Observed:	Huawei Technologies Lebanon - Training Area
Number of Employees You Saw:	5 employees
Type of Industry: (e.g.: Manufacturing, Hospitality, IT, Service)	ICT infrastructure and telecommunications
What the Company Does: What services do they offer, what do they make, what do they do?	The company supplies network-connectivity systems, smart devices, cloud and computing services, and technology training.
Tasks Observed: What tasks/work do you see taking place?	I observed a technical lesson on 4G networks, trainee guidance, university-program coordination, and support for recruitment activities.
Skills Observed: What skills do you see being used?	Technical teaching, public speaking, active listening, planning, problem solving, and collaboration.
Working Hours: What are start and finish times? What are tea and lunch break times?	The normal schedule starts around 8:00-9:00 AM and ends around 5:00-6:00 PM, with a lunch break near midday.
Employee Interaction: Can you observe how employees interact with each other? Describe what you see.	Employees exchanged information clearly and divided responsibilities efficiently. They answered questions politely and supported one another.
Employee Satisfaction: Do the employees look happy, like they are enjoying their job? Explain why you think this.	The staff appeared focused and motivated. They worked calmly and showed confidence when discussing their areas of expertise.
Customers: Who are the main customers?	Consumers, telecom carriers, organizations, and university students participating in company programs.
Customer Service (1): What did you notice?	Employees adjusted their explanations to suit the listener and used clear examples.
Customer Service (2): Did you observe any good or bad interactions with customers?	I observed good service. Staff remained patient, friendly, and responsive; no negative interaction was seen.
Main Relevant Jobs Observed (1): List a job you observed. Briefly, what does this job involve?	Training Instructor Prepares and delivers sessions on networking and telecommunications topics for trainees.
Main Relevant Jobs Observed (2): List a job you observed. Briefly, what does this job involve?	PR & ICT Ecosystem Specialist Communicates with universities and organizes student programs, competitions, and recruitment.

Main Relevant Jobs Observed (3): List a job you observed. Briefly, what does this job involve?	Senior HR Specialist Supports recruitment, employee relations, and other human-resources processes.
Main Equipment Observed: List and explain some of the main equipment you saw?	Network routers were used to explain 4G topology. Laptops, tablets, and presentation tools supported the demonstration.
Devices that Were used for Customer Service: What devices were used when the staff interacted with customers?	Laptops and tablets were used to present information and interact with trainees and customers.
Workplace Safety (1): Did you see any health and safety signs? Describe and draw them on the back of this form.	No health and safety signs were visible in the office and training spaces that I visited.
Workplace Safety (2): Did you see any safety clothing? Describe it.	Employees did not wear safety clothing because the work took place in an office and training environment.
Dress Code: What do you notice about how the workers are dressed?	The workers wore formal business attire that reflected the professional corporate setting.
Workplace Energy: Does this look like a fun or interesting place to work? Why/why not?	Yes. The environment was dynamic and engaging because it combined technical learning, teamwork, and interaction with trainees.
Possible Work Experience Opportunities: Do you think there might be work experience or internship opportunities here? Why?	Training and internship opportunities are likely because the company organizes programs and competitions for university students.
Manager or Supervisor's Name: List here if you were able to get this information.	Ms. Ruba Msheik - PR & ICT Ecosystem Specialist Ms. Patricia Farah - Senior HR Specialist No manager or supervisor was directly observed.